

Chira the Chick and the Way Home

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Chira was a tiny yellow chick. She lived in a nest under the rose bush. One morning, Chira chased a butterfly. Flap flap flutter! She chased it past the fence. She chased it past the pond. She chased it into the tall grass. Then the butterfly flew away. Chira looked around. Nothing looked familiar. Oh no! She was lost. Chira felt frightened. Her little heart pounded. "I do not know the way home," she peeped. A tear slid down her beak.



Her friend Tansy the tortoise ambled by. Tortoises walk slowly, but they know every path. "Why are you crying, little chick?" asked Tansy. "I am lost," sobbed Chira. "I chased a butterfly too far." Tansy nodded kindly. "Then we will follow the friendly sounds home," she said. "Follow the friendly sound home." "Follow the friendly sound home." Chira repeated it softly. "Follow the friendly sound home." It became their guiding words. "Follow the friendly sound home."



Tansy lifted her wrinkled head. "Listen," she whispered. Far away, a hen was clucking. Cluck cluck cluck. "That is my mama!" cried Chira. "Follow the friendly sound home," said Tansy. They walked toward the clucking. Step by step. Tansy walked slowly. Chira walked slowly beside her. Cluck cluck cluck. Louder now. Chira felt hopeful. She felt braver. The sound was leading them home.



Can you listen like Chira? Close your eyes. What do you hear? Pretend you hear: cluck cluck cluck! They passed the pond. They passed the fence. The rose bush came into view. "Mama!" peeped Chira. She ran the last few steps. Her mama wrapped her in warm wings. "My lost chick is found!" clucked Mama. Chira felt safe. She felt loved. Tansy smiled and waved goodbye.



That night, Chira snuggled in the nest. Her mama's wing was warm over her. "Thank you, Tansy," whispered Chira. "Sleep tight, little traveler," said Tansy from below. Chira closed her eyes. She heard the night sounds, soft and friendly. Crickets, breeze, and Mama's breathing. Cluck, breathe, sleep. And Chira drifted into the coziest sleep.

Moral: *Listening carefully and walking slowly can guide you home.*

The End